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Principal Software Developer (Ref: 17500)

Ministry of Justice

Apply before 11:55 pm on Monday 15th June 2026

Ministry of
JUSTICE

Reference number

464738

Salary

£71,381 - £85,257

The national salary is £71,381 - £80,419. London salary is £75,674 - £85,257. Your salary will be dependent on your base location.

London: £75,674 - £87,875 (which may include an allowance of up to £12,201)

National: £71,381 - £83,700 (which may include an allowance of up to £12,319)

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 6
MOJ Grade 6

Contract type

Permanent

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Part-time

Number of jobs available

3

Contents

Location

About the job

Benefits

Things you need to know

Apply and further information

Location

East Midlands (England), East of England, London (region), North East England, North West England, Scotland, South East England, South West England, Wales, West Midlands (England), Yorkshire and the Humber

About the job

Job summary

This is a Nationally based role

Job description

Principal Software Developer

Location: National*

Interviews: w/c 29 June

Grade: 6

(MoJ candidates who are on a specialist grade, will be able to retain this grade on lateral transfer)

Salary (for more information, please see below):**

London: £75,674 - £87,875 (which may include an allowance of up to £12,201)

National: £71,381 - £83,700 (which may include an allowance of up to £12,319)

Working pattern: full-time, part-time, flexible working

Contract Type: Permanent

Number of vacancies: 3

Vacancy number: 17500

***We offer a hybrid working model, allowing for a balance between remote work and time spent in your local office. Office locations can be found [ON THIS MAP](#)**

Please note that unless you are an existing member of staff at Justice Digital, Data and Science, the only London location being recruited to is 10 South Colonnade, E14 4PU. We are no longer recruiting to 102 Petty France, SW1H 9AJ.

The Role

Please note this role requires you to pass [Security Check](#) clearance. Please click on the [link](#) for details.

We're recruiting for three Principal Software Developers here at [Justice Digital, Data and Science](#), to be part of our warm and collaborative Office of the Chief Technology Officer (OCTO), Legal Aid Digital (LAA) and Prisons and Probation Digital (HMPPS) designing and delivering digital services that make a genuine difference to people's lives, alongside championing the adoption of emerging technologies.

The Principal Developer will work under the Chief Engineer and alongside the Head of Profession for Engineering and will drive the product teams within OCTO, LAA and HMPPS, as well as acting as a leader within the software development profession across the MOJ.

This is a hands-on technical role where you'll work directly with product teams across the department, bringing your expertise to help deliver solutions that reduce friction and improve engineering practices across Justice Digital, Data and Science. You'll guide the Chief Engineer's product teams while providing leadership to the wider software development profession at MOJ. Beyond delivery, you'll also be expected to horizon scan and experiment with new products and tools in an R&D capacity, identifying emerging technologies that could benefit the organisation.

This role aligns against [the Principal Developer role](#) from the Government Digital and Data Framework.

Key Responsibilities

Work with the Chief Engineer to define, maintain and own CTO's engineering strategy, aligning with its wider business objectives.

Oversee and guide technical teams, influence technical choices and seek out opportunities for digital transformation including:

Lead the Developer Assurance team, comprised of Staff Engineers, to ensure that development standards are maintained across

Justice Digital, Data and Science

Lead the Engineering Standards team to develop and deliver a world class development portal, that documents Justice Digital, Data and Science engineering standards

Work alongside the Principal DevOps Engineer to work with the DevX team, working on R&D projects to scope out new and emerging technologies to adopt across the department.

Mentor, coach, and line manage lead and senior developers

Look for opportunities to collaborate and reuse common components, communicating with both technical and non-technical stakeholders.

Build and maintain an inclusive culture across the software development community.

Manage recruitment and allocation of developers to teams, identifying gaps in capability, ensuring a good balance of skills and seniority.

Work with the engineering principals across other agencies to help break down silos and work on cross cutting initiatives.

If this feels like an exciting challenge, something you are enthusiastic about, and want to join our team please read on and apply!

Person Specification

Essential:

Experience leading and growing software development teams and technical capability and fostering an inclusive, high-performing team culture.

Expertise designing, building and operating reliable, secure, and maintainable digital services.

Experience coaching, mentoring and line managing senior developers or technical leads.

Confidence working within agile environments to iteratively working software designed around the users need.

Confidence working across teams and reaching out across organisational/ team boundaries to understand common technical approaches and patterns.

Experience supporting live services and managing technical risks.

Code review.

Willingness to be assessed against [the requirements](#) for SC clearance.

We welcome the unique contribution diverse applicants bring and do not discriminate based on culture, ethnicity, race, nationality or national origin, age, sex, gender identity or expression, religion or belief, disability status, sexual orientation, educational or social background or any other factor.

Our values are Purpose, Humanity Openness and Together. Find out more [here](#) about how we celebrate diversity and an inclusive culture in our workplace.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan](#) and the [Civil Service D&I Strategy](#).

Salary Information**

Base salary for this role is from £71,381 to £80,419 (National) or from £75,674 to £85,257 (London).

New entrants to the Civil Service joining the MoJ are expected to start at the minimum of the pay band.

Existing Civil Servants moving on a level transfer will retain their current base salary or move to the minimum of the pay band for the role, whichever is higher.

Existing Civil Servants who are promoted will either move to the bottom of the new grade's pay band or receive a 10% uplift, whichever provides the greater increase.

Candidates may also be eligible for a non-pensionable Government Digital & Data Allowance of up to £12,201 per year (London) or £12,319

(National). This is a temporary allowance, reviewed annually and may be retained, amended, or withdrawn.

The final offer will reflect the skills and experience you demonstrate during the assessment process.

Why JDDS?

Over the past year, we have strengthened our focus on attracting and retaining women and non-binary people in technical roles across the Ministry of Justice. We have steadily been increasing representation through targeted activity, including community forums, support and mentoring, and visible senior allyship committed to sustained improvement.

We're proud to back this up with action. Our internal **Women in Digital, Data and Science Forum** builds community for women and non-binary colleagues across all grades, creating space to share experiences, grow confidence, and shape practical changes. We also [support cross-government work](#) to remove barriers for women and girls entering and progressing in tech, and we offer routes in through **apprenticeships** and structured development.

We're proud that this work is recognised externally too: Justice Digital, Data and Science (Ministry of Justice) was named **Best Employer of the Year** at the [Women in Tech Excellence Awards 2025](#).

Read more about our work and culture in the blog posts below:

[Six Months in Building the Women in Engineering Working Group](#), by Rosie Bringham, Deputy Head of Profession for Engineering.

[Designing Digital Services for Everyone: Why LGBTQ+ History Still Matters](#), by Mark Stanley, Deputy Director for Prisons.

[It started with a Quiz: Discovering a Different Kind of Strength](#), by Eva Horvathova, Capability Manager.

Our values are Purpose, Humanity, Openness and Together. Find out more [here](#) about how we celebrate diversity and foster an inclusive culture in our workplace.

Use of Artificial Intelligence

Artificial Intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Terms & Conditions

Please review our [Terms and Conditions](#) which set out how we recruit and provide further information related to the role and salary arrangements.

If you have any questions, please feel free to contact digitalanddatarecruitment@justice.gov.uk

Person specification

Please refer to the attached Job Description

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £71,381, Ministry of Justice contributes £20,679 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides.](#)

Access to learning and development

A working environment that supports a range of flexible working options to enhance your work life balance

A working culture which encourages inclusion and diversity

A Civil Service pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Annual Leave

Public Holidays

Season Ticket Advance

For more information about the recruitment process, benefits and allowances and answers to general queries, please click the below link which will direct you to our Candidate Information Page.

Link: <https://justicejobs.tal.net/vx/candidate/cms/About%20the%20MOJ>

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

How to Apply

In Justice Digital, Data and Science, we recruit using a combination of the [Government Digital and Data Profession Capability](#) and [Success Profiles](#) Frameworks. We shall assess a combination of your Experience, Technical skills and Behaviours during the assessment process.

Stage 1 - Application and sift:

To apply for this position, you must submit the following as part of your application:

A **CV** detailing your career history (including any relevant qualifications). Your CV will be assessed against the essential criteria outlined within the Person Specification of this advert.

A **Personal Statement**(no more than 750 words) which should outline your experience and skills, giving clear examples of work undertaken. It should specifically address the following 2 criteria listed below, using a separate paragraph for each.

Experience coaching, mentoring and line managing senior developers or technical leads.

Confidence working within agile environments to iteratively working software designed around the users need.

A diverse sift panel will review the information in your CV and Personal Statement to assess the sift criteria specified above. We operate an anonymous shortlisting process. **Please ensure your CV and Personal Statement do not include your name or any other identifying details.**

Should we receive a high volume of applications, a pre-sift based on the same criteria (Experience coaching, mentoring and line managing senior developers or technical leads and Confidence working within agile environments to iteratively working software designed around the users need) will be conducted before the sift.

Please access the following link for guidance on how to apply - [Application Guidance](#)

Stage 2 - Interviews:

Successful candidates who meet the required standard will then be invited to a panel interview held via Microsoft Teams. At interview stage, you will be assessed against the following Success Profile elements - Experience, Technical and the following Behaviours:

Leadership

Seeing the Big Picture

Communicating and influencing

As part of your interview, you will be asked to deliver **a short technical test** that assesses your technical capability. Further details will be provided if successful at sift.

Appointments are made strictly in merit order. In the event that two or more candidates receive identical interview scores, the behaviour Communicating and influencing will be applied as the primary lead criterion to determine the final merit order.

Should you be unsuccessful in the role that you have applied for but demonstrate the capability for a role at a lower level, we reserve the right to discuss this opportunity with you and offer you the position without needing a further application.

A reserve list may be held for up to 12 months, from which further appointments may be made.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check \(opens in a new window\)](#).

[See our vetting charter \(opens in a new window\)](#).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals

- nationals of the Republic of Ireland

- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status

under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name :	SSCL Recruitment Enquiries Team
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk
Telephone :	0345 241 5359
Recruitment team	
Email :	moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@resourcing.soprasteria.co.uk

Further information

Appointment to the Civil Service is governed by the Civil Service Commission's Recruitment Principles. If you feel a department has breached the requirement of the Recruitment Principles and would like to raise this, please contact SSCL (Moj-recruitment-vetting-enquiries@gov.sscl.com) in the first instance. If the role has been advertised externally (outside of the Civil Service) and you are not satisfied with the response, you may bring your complaint to the Commission. For further information on bringing a complaint to the Civil Service Commission please visit their web pages: <http://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/civil-service-recruitment/complaints/>

<https://www.jobtrain.co.uk/justicedigital/Job/JobDetail?jobid=1068&isPreview=Yes&advert=external>

